

F5 Daily Briefing - Tuesday, August 18, 2026

Daily competitive intelligence covering 22 F5 competitors

22

COMPETITORS TRACKED

20

ANNOUNCEMENTS

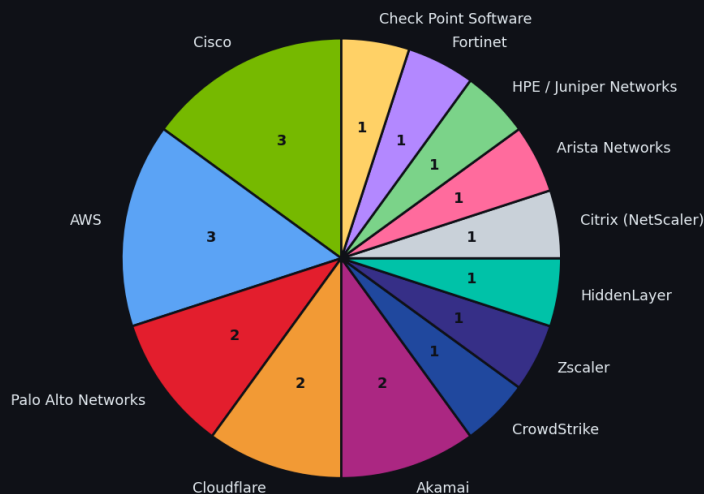
13

ACTIVE

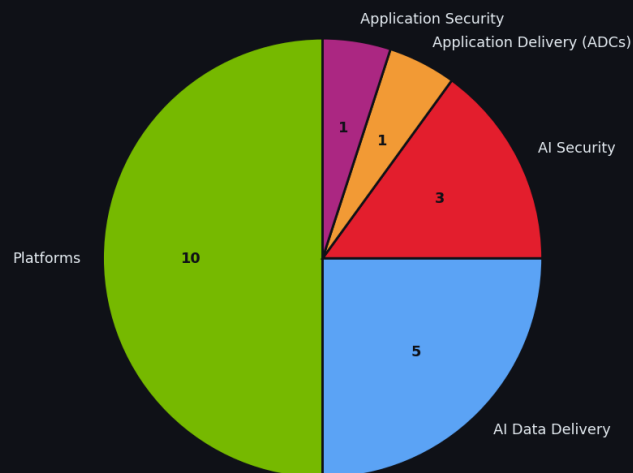
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ACTIVE CATEGORIES

Announcements by Competitor



Announcements by Category



ALL ANNOUNCEMENTS (20)

PRODUCT LAUNCH

AWS

Platforms

2026-08-18

AWS IAM Identity Federation to External Services Now Available in European Sovereign Cloud

AWS extended IAM identity federation to external services into the AWS European Sovereign Cloud Region. The capability lets workloads running in the sovereign cloud federate identities outward to external services, supporting customers with EU digital sovereignty and data residency requirements. It expands the sovereign cloud's identity and access management parity with commercial AWS Regions for regulated European public sector and enterprise workloads.

Source: <https://aws.amazon.com/about-aws/whats-new/2026/08/aws-iam-european-sovereign-cloud/>

PRODUCT LAUNCH

AWS

Platforms

2026-08-18

IAM Policy Autopilot Now Supports Terraform Plan Files

AWS added Terraform plan file support to IAM Policy Autopilot. The tool can now deterministically generate baseline IAM policies scoped to the CRUD operations of resources defined in a Terraform plan, reducing manual least-privilege policy authoring for infrastructure-as-code deployments. This extends Policy Autopilot beyond its earlier inputs and helps platform and security teams enforce tighter permissions earlier in the pipeline.

Source: <https://aws.amazon.com/about-aws/whats-new/2026/08/iam-policy-autopilot-now-supports-terraform-plan-files/>

AWARD**Akamai****Platforms**

2026-08-18

Akamai Named a Leader in The Forrester Wave: Microsegmentation Solutions, Q3 2026

Akamai announced that Akamai Guardicore Segmentation was named a Leader in The Forrester Wave: Microsegmentation Solutions, Q3 2026. Forrester evaluated 10 vendors across 25 criteria, awarding Akamai the highest possible scores in asset discovery, flow enrichment, visualization, policy administration, public cloud enforcement, ZTNA integration, exposure reporting, threat detection and response, innovation, and supporting services. Akamai positions the win as validation that microsegmentation can be fast, simple, and safe to operationalize at enterprise scale.

Source: <https://www.akamai.com/blog/security/akamai-2026-forrester-wave-leader-microsegmentation>

PARTNERSHIP**Cisco****Platforms**

2026-08-18

Cisco and Auvik Partner to Simplify Network Modernization for AI

Cisco outlined a joint approach with Auvik to close visibility gaps across Cisco, Meraki, and multi-vendor networks as customers modernize for AI workloads. The combination adds automatic device discovery, real-time topology mapping, performance and traffic monitoring with user-experience data, and always-current configuration documentation with historical snapshots. Cisco frames the result as evidence-based modernization prioritization, letting teams rank edge analytics sites, aging switches, and mixed-vendor environments while feeding network intelligence into broader Cisco IT workflows.

Source: <https://blogs.cisco.com/networking/how-cisco-and-auvik-simplify-network-modernization-for-ai>

COMPANY NEWS**Cisco****Platforms**

2026-08-18

Cisco Meraki Powers the Cincinnati Open with All-Cloud-Managed Network

Cisco detailed how BEEMOK Capital, Cisco, and Emerge built a cloud-first network foundation at the Lindner Family Tennis Center for the Cincinnati Open, designed for year-round operation rather than a two-week event. The deployment spans 40 miles of underground conduit, 17 miles of fiber, and 90 miles of copper, with 320 Meraki Wi-Fi access points and 100 Catalyst 9300-M switches. It enables real-time guest counting, demand-based food and beverage inventory, and high-bandwidth AI-enabled fan experiences.

Source: <https://newsroom.cisco.com/c/r/newsroom/en/us/a/y2026/m08/from-first-serve-to-match-point-inside-the-technology-powering-the-cincinnati-open.html>

BLOG POST**Cloudflare****Platforms**

2026-08-18

BGP Role Model: Tracking the Adoption of RFC 9234

Cloudflare published an adoption status update on RFC 9234, the BGP Role and Only-to-Customer (OTC) attribute mechanism that prevents route leaks. The post tracks vendor support as of August 2026, noting Junos OS, RouterOS, BIRD, OpenBGPD, and FRR support it, with Cisco IOS XR arriving in 26.4.1, while Arista EOS, Nokia SR OS, and Huawei still lack it. Cloudflare says it has begun gradually deploying BGP Role configuration across its global router fleet and urges operators to enable it during maintenance windows.

Source: <https://blog.cloudflare.com/rfc9234-bgp-role-model/>

[COMPANY NEWS](#)[Cloudflare](#)[Platforms](#)

2026-08-18

Cloudflare Brings AI Security and Agentic Infrastructure Vision to LEAP 2026

Cloudflare announced it will bring its AI security and agentic infrastructure story to LEAP 2026 in Riyadh, focusing on how organizations build and protect AI applications and establish governance for scaling AI workloads. The company will engage government, enterprise, partner, and developer audiences across the Middle East, Turkey, and Africa, with a regional team at Booth H3 C50 discussing securing, building, and optimizing AI applications on Cloudflare's network.

Source: <https://www.intelligentciso.com/2026/08/18/cloudflare-brings-ai-security-and-agentic-infrastructure-vision-to-leap-2026/>

[PARTNERSHIP](#)[CrowdStrike](#)[Platforms](#)

2026-08-18

Endace Integrates Always-On Packet Capture with CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Gen SIEM

Endace announced an integration that embeds EndaceProbe always-on packet capture directly into CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Gen SIEM, making packet-level evidence accessible inside the Falcon console. Analysts can correlate full packet data with security telemetry to accelerate investigations, strengthen threat hunting, and improve visibility across hybrid and multi-cloud environments, including retrospective analysis of historical incidents. The integration is available now through the CrowdStrike Marketplace, extending Falcon's SIEM ecosystem into network forensics.

Source: <https://www.endace.com/endace-announces-integration-with-crowdstrike-falcon-next-gen-siem>

[THREAT INTELLIGENCE](#)[Palo Alto Networks](#)[Platforms](#)

2026-08-18

Unit 42 Updates Threat Brief on Large-Scale Credential Attacks

Palo Alto Networks Unit 42 updated its threat brief on large-scale credential attacks, adding details on the actor "TheHatman" who claimed to exfiltrate data from multiple enterprise Microsoft Entra tenants in early August 2026. The brief ties activity to the broader "FortiBleed" credential-stuffing campaign and reports blocked suspicious logins in customer telemetry. Guidance emphasizes auditing remote-access logs, hardening edge devices, and enforcing phishing-resistant MFA, with product mappings to Cortex Cloud and Idira identity offerings.

Source: <https://unit42.paloaltonetworks.com/large-scale-credential-attacks/>

[PARTNERSHIP](#)[Zscaler](#)[Platforms](#)

2026-08-18

Zscaler and Carahsoft Expand Partnership to Bring Zero Trust Exchange to SMB and Mid-Market

Zscaler expanded its partnership with Carahsoft to extend the Zscaler Zero Trust Exchange platform to SMB and mid-market customers in the U.S. The program uses Carahsoft's distribution and reseller ecosystem to deliver standardized, SMB-ready offers with simplified consumption and predictable pricing. Zscaler positions it as a way for smaller organizations to replace legacy security stacks with cloud-delivered Zero Trust without enterprise-scale complexity, backed by joint go-to-market, co-selling, and streamlined procurement.

Source: <https://www.zscaler.com/press/zscaler-and-carahsoft-expand-partnership-deliver-enterprise-proven-zero-trust-security-smb>

ACQUISITION

Fortinet

AI Security

2026-08-18

Fortinet Acquires Virtue AI to Secure Agentic AI and Add Runtime Protection

Fortinet's acquisition of Virtue AI extends its Security for AI strategy with AI runtime protection, continuous automated validation, and governance for autonomous agents. Virtue AI's Guardian Agent discovers AI agents and tools, flags unsanctioned applications, scans for vulnerabilities, and blocks risky tool calls, while automated red-teaming runs across 50+ sandboxed environments and 14 high-stakes domains with real-time multimodal guardrails. The capabilities complement FortiAI Gate and the AI-native Security Fabric; financial terms were undisclosed and deemed immaterial.

Source: <https://aimagazine.com/news/how-fortinets-virtue-ai-acquisition-helps-secure-agentic-ai>

PARTNERSHIP

HiddenLayer

AI Security

2026-08-18

HiddenLayer Selected to Support DOE's \$60M Prometheus Initiative Under the Genesis Mission

HiddenLayer joined the Department of Energy's Prometheus initiative, a \$60 million Phase II program under the Genesis Mission led by Idaho National Laboratory, to secure AI-enabled applications across the U.S. nuclear energy sector and critical infrastructure. HiddenLayer will contribute lifecycle AI security expertise spanning risk identification, vulnerability testing, attack simulation, and runtime protection, working alongside Oak Ridge, Argonne, and Sandia national labs plus academic and industry partners. CEO Chris Sestito framed AI security as essential to advancing energy and national security objectives.

Source: <https://www.prnewswire.com/news-releases/hiddenlayer-selected-to-support-does-60-million-prometheus-initiative-under-the-genesis-mission-302853514.html>

PRODUCT LAUNCH

Palo Alto Networks

AI Security

2026-08-18

Palo Alto Networks Rolls Out Koi Agentic Endpoint Security Enhancements

Palo Alto Networks detailed a quarter of innovation in Koi Agentic Endpoint Security (AES) following its Koi acquisition, delivering end-to-end lifecycle visibility for every AI agent, browser extension, and account in the environment. The release advances discovery, runtime enforcement, and remediation so teams can inventory agents, define permissible actions, and remove unauthorized components without slowing innovation. Agentic AI is now embedded in the default SOC workflow to accelerate security operations beyond what most programs can manually track.

Source: <https://www.paloaltonetworks.com/blog/security-operations/a-quarter-of-innovation-with-koi-agentic-endpoint-security/>

PRODUCT LAUNCH

AWS

AI Data Delivery

2026-08-18

Amazon Bedrock AgentCore Payments Is Now Generally Available

AWS made AgentCore payments generally available in Amazon Bedrock AgentCore, letting AI agents autonomously discover, access, and pay for paid APIs, MCP servers, and content with minimal code. It integrates Coinbase and Stripe Privy wallets for microtransactions, enforces configurable payment limits at the infrastructure layer, and provides end-to-end visibility through AgentCore Observability. GA additions include Quick Create for Coinbase credential provisioning, a curated Coinbase Bazar MCP server for pay-per-use x402 endpoints via AgentCore Gateway, and x402 pricing for pay-per-inference use cases.

Source: <https://aws.amazon.com/about-aws/whats-new/2026/08/bedrock-agentcore-payments-ga/>

PRODUCT LAUNCH

Akamai

AI Data Delivery

2026-08-18

Akamai Launches Valkey Managed Database for Real-Time Enterprise AI Memory

Akamai launched Valkey Managed Database, a fully managed, high-performance in-memory data platform built on the open-source Valkey ecosystem and integrated with Akamai Cloud. It gives AI-native applications real-time data access, memory, and context for inference, aiming to cut operational complexity, lower inference costs, and speed time to value. Akamai's cloud changelog lists the release as limited availability, using public Let's Encrypt CA certificates for TLS.

Source: <https://www.akamai.com/blog/cloud/valkey-managed-database-real-time-memory-enterprise-ai>

COMPANY NEWS

Arista Networks

AI Data Delivery

2026-08-18

Arista Details Etherlink AI Fabric Growth to 100+ Customers at Rosenblatt Age of AI Summit

Arista CFO Chantelle Breithaupt and VP of Product Line Management Brendan Gibbs presented at Rosenblatt's 6th Annual Technology Summit: The Age of AI (Part II), disclosing that the Etherlink AI-optimized networking family has grown from roughly 4-5 customers in 2024 to more than 100 customers today. The fireside chat broke down the customer mix across cloud titans, AI labs, neoclouds, and sovereign enterprises, and addressed where incremental AI fabric revenue will come from relative to first-half 2026.

Source: <https://seekingalpha.com/article/4937952-arista-networks-inc-anet-presents-at-rosenblatts-6th-annual-technology-summit-the-age-of-ai>

RESEARCH

Cisco

AI Data Delivery

2026-08-18

Cisco-Commissioned Omdia Report Shows Why AI Workload Placement Matters

Cisco published findings from a new Omdia study of 1,201 IT decision makers on where AI workloads should run, arguing that cloud-versus-on-premises placement drives performance, cost, and agility outcomes. The report highlights widespread "AI infrastructure regret," with many organizations revisiting initial placement decisions because of control, power, and data-center economics. Cisco positions its unified data center architecture, including Nexus One, as the way to optimize AI workloads across hybrid environments.

Source: <https://blogs.cisco.com/news/cloud-or-on-premises-new-report-shows-why-ai-workload-placement-matters>

COMPANY NEWS

HPE / Juniper Networks

AI Data Delivery

2026-08-18

HPE Expands Academic Alliance Program to 176 Indian Universities for AI-Native Networking Skills

HPE announced its Academic Alliance Program in India has expanded to 176 universities, reaching more than 18,000 students in 2026. The program upskills students and faculty in AI-native networking, cloud, security, and automated operations, drawing directly on HPE's post-Juniper Mist AI and self-driving network portfolio. HPE framed the expansion as advancing education and research while strengthening India's digital infrastructure and building industry-relevant competencies in AI-driven networking across higher education.

Source: <https://connect-converge.com/hpe-expands-academic-alliance-program-across-176-indian-universities-to-build-ai-native-networking-skills/>

BLOG POST

Citrix (NetScaler)

Application Delivery (ADCs)

2026-08-18

NetScaler Pushes “It's Not Always the Network” Application Delivery ROI Message

A NetScaler-focused thought leadership piece argues enterprises overinvest in raw network capacity while neglecting the application delivery layer between users and critical apps. It cites a 2025 IDC study showing organizations using the NetScaler Application Delivery and Security Platform achieved 387% three-year ROI, 97% less unplanned downtime, and 23% fewer security breaches. The article positions intelligent traffic management, application acceleration, secure remote access, and advanced analytics as the differentiators in hybrid and multicloud environments.

Source: <https://techeconomy.ng/breaking-news-its-not-always-the-network>

THREAT INTELLIGENCE

Check Point Software

Application Security

2026-08-18

Thousands of Hacked WordPress Sites, One Operation: Unmasking StopAndProtect

Check Point Research published an investigation into StopAndProtect, an operation that hijacked roughly 2,000 compromised WordPress domains to distribute malware, control infected hosts, and store stolen documents, screenshots, and logs. The infection chain begins with a ClickFix social-engineering lure triggering PowerShell, then deploys a .NET suite including ransomware, an SMB/USB worm, a lock screen, and a credential stealer. Attacker OPSEC failures exposed victim logs and internal tooling, revealing more than 5,000 infected machines concentrated in the US, Russia, and India.

Source: <https://research.checkpoint.com/2026/thousands-of-hacked-wordpress-sites-one-operation-unmasking-stopandprotect/>